

Nashville Neighborhood Redevelopment & Zoning Capacity Analysis

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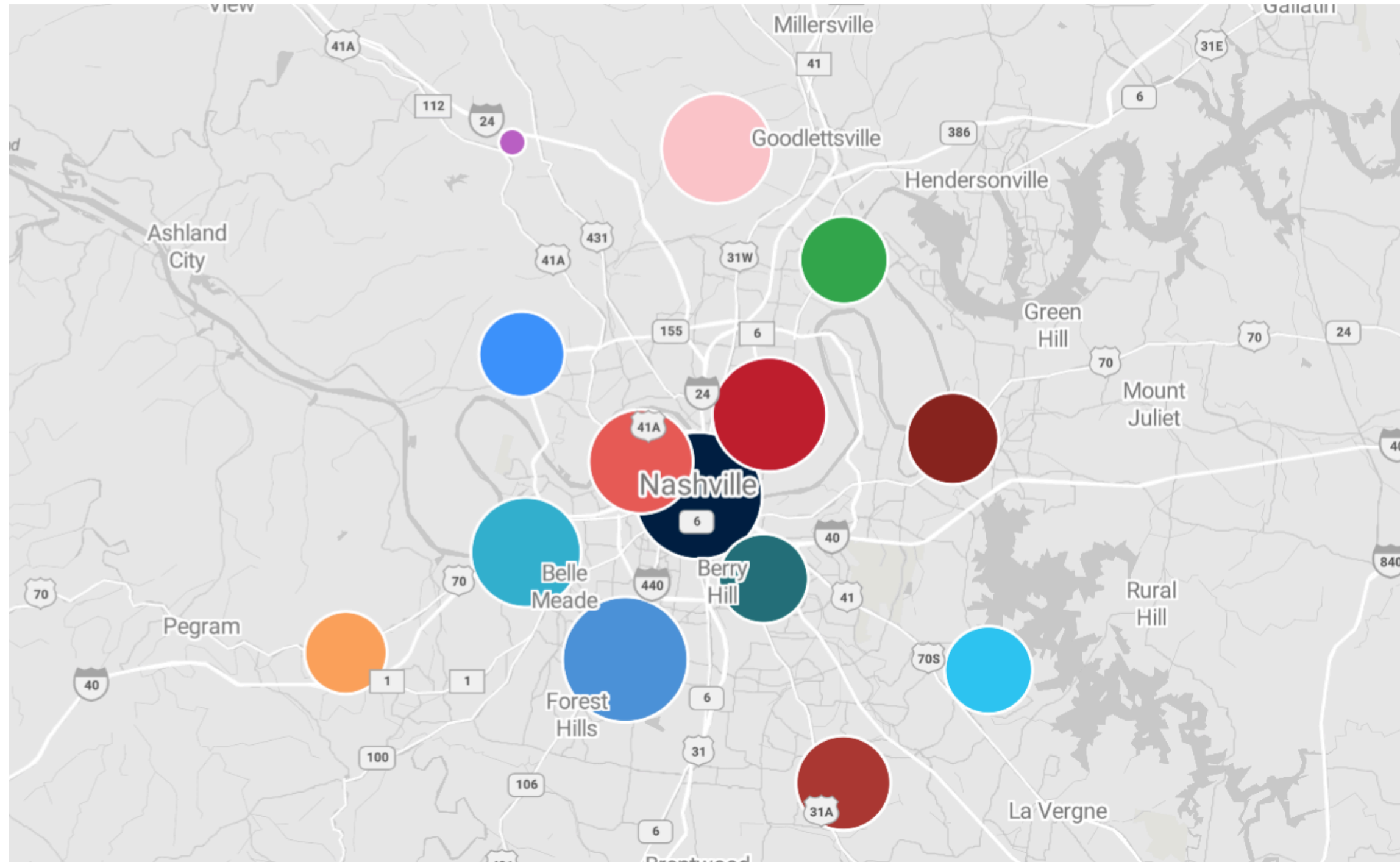
Executive Summary

Nashville's Neighborhood Transformation Index (NTI) quantifies how quickly neighborhoods are changing by measuring the alignment between zoning capacity, market behavior, and on-the-ground development. Higher scores reflect areas where increased zoning intensity, rising prices, and active permitting converge, indicating accelerated redevelopment pressure. Lower scores reflect limited construction activity or restrictive zoning environments, signaling slower, more incremental change. The index provides a structured, comparative view of where transformation is occurring and the factors driving it.

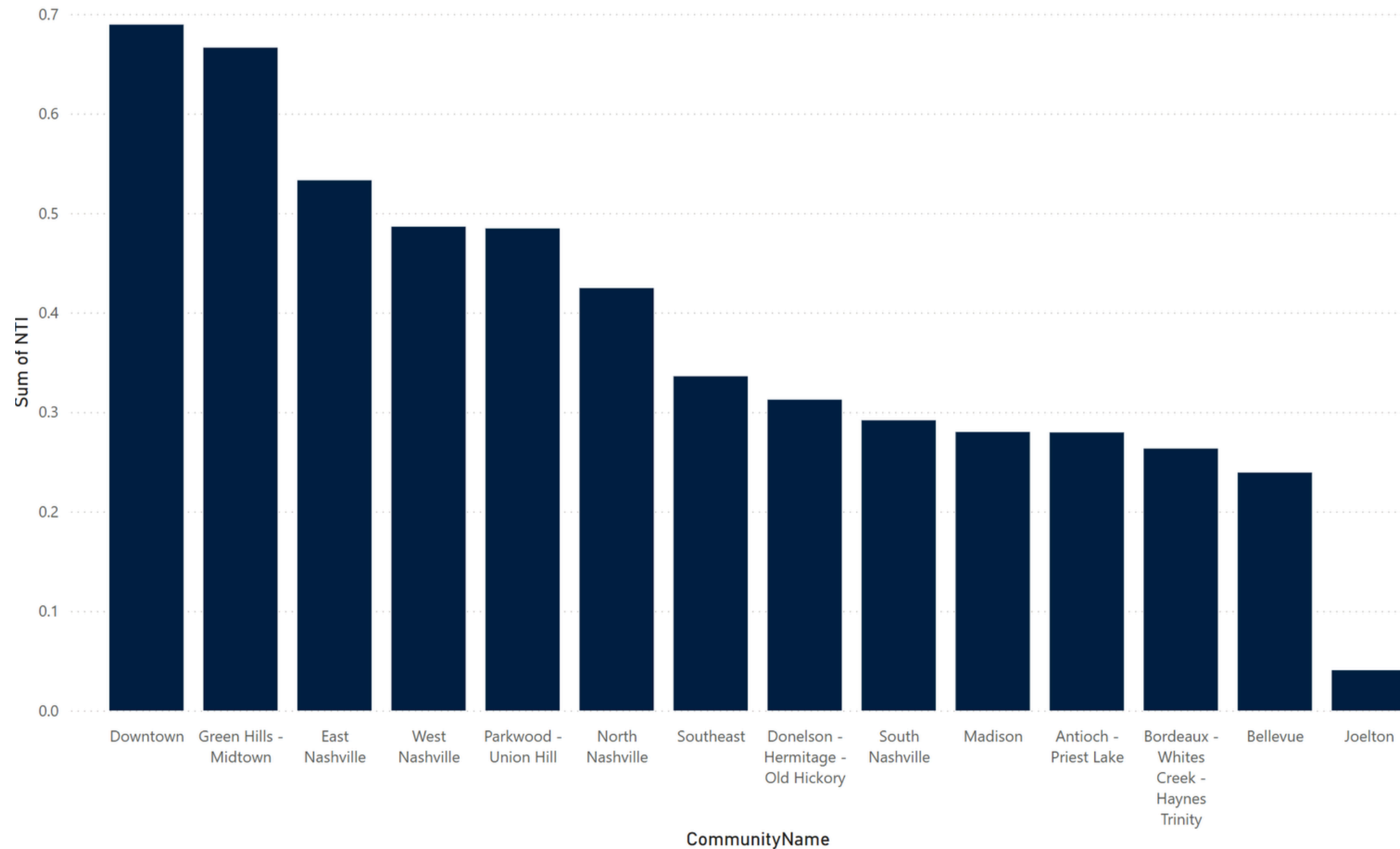
The project's core temporal window is defined by permit activity from March 3, 2023 through December 17, 2024. Historical sales records extend from 1900 through February 2026, offering long-term context for interpreting price trends and neighborhood trajectories.

All data used in this project was found on nashville.gov.

NTI Overview Map



NTI Distribution



The distribution of NTI (Neighborhood Transformation Index) scores shows how neighborhoods vary in their redevelopment pressure. The top-scoring neighborhoods stand out with consistently strong signals, while the lowest-scoring areas show weaker or inconsistent indicators. This page highlights the range of transformation across the city.

What this chart shows

- Each bar represents the total NTI (Neighborhood Transformation Index) score for a neighborhood, reflecting how strongly zoning capacity, price momentum, and development activity align.
- Higher values indicate stronger redevelopment pressure; lower values indicate weaker or inconsistent signals.

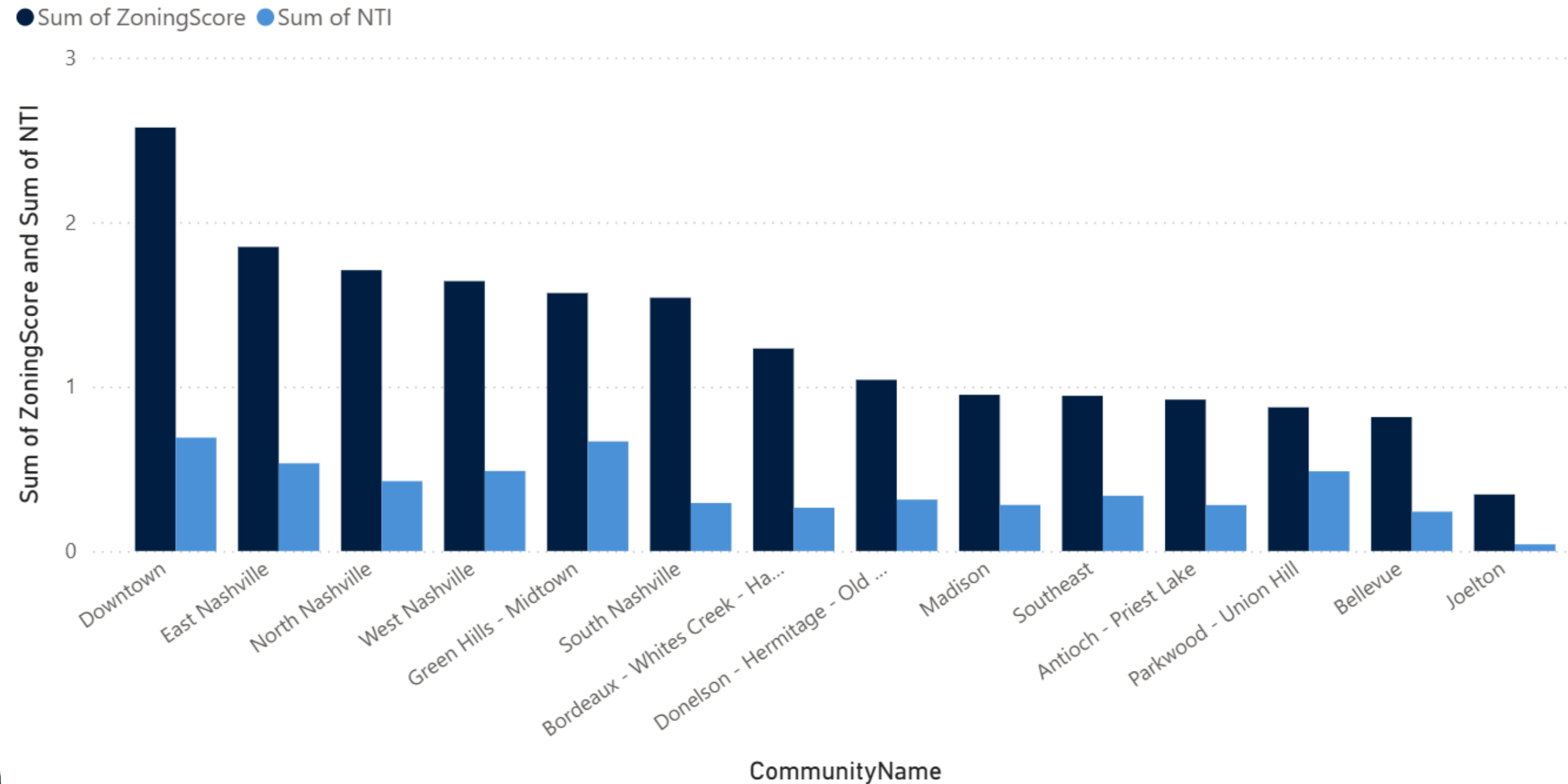
What the distribution reveals

- Top-scoring neighborhoods (Downtown, Green Hills–Midtown, East Nashville) show consistent strength across all NTI components.
- Mid-range neighborhoods show partial alignment—strong in one factor but weaker in another.
- Lower-scoring areas (Joelton, Bellevue, Parkwood–Union Hill) show limited construction activity or zoning constraints, signaling slower change.

Why this matters

- The distribution highlights the range of transformation across the city and clarifies where redevelopment pressure is concentrated versus where it remains limited.

Zoning Capacity



Zoning capacity reflects how much additional development a neighborhood can support under current regulations. Neighborhoods with higher zoning capacity tend to have more room for growth and are better positioned for redevelopment. This metric helps explain why some areas show stronger transformation potential than others.

Zoning capacity was calculated by comparing each parcel's current built form to what its zoning district allows. Parcels with a large gap between what exists today and what could legally be built were classified as having higher unused capacity, while parcels already near their allowable limits were classified as lower-capacity.

What this chart shows

- Bars represent total zoning capacity (ZoningScore) for each neighborhood.
- The NTI (Neighborhood Transformation Index) values alongside them show how zoning potential aligns with actual redevelopment pressure.

What the comparison reveals

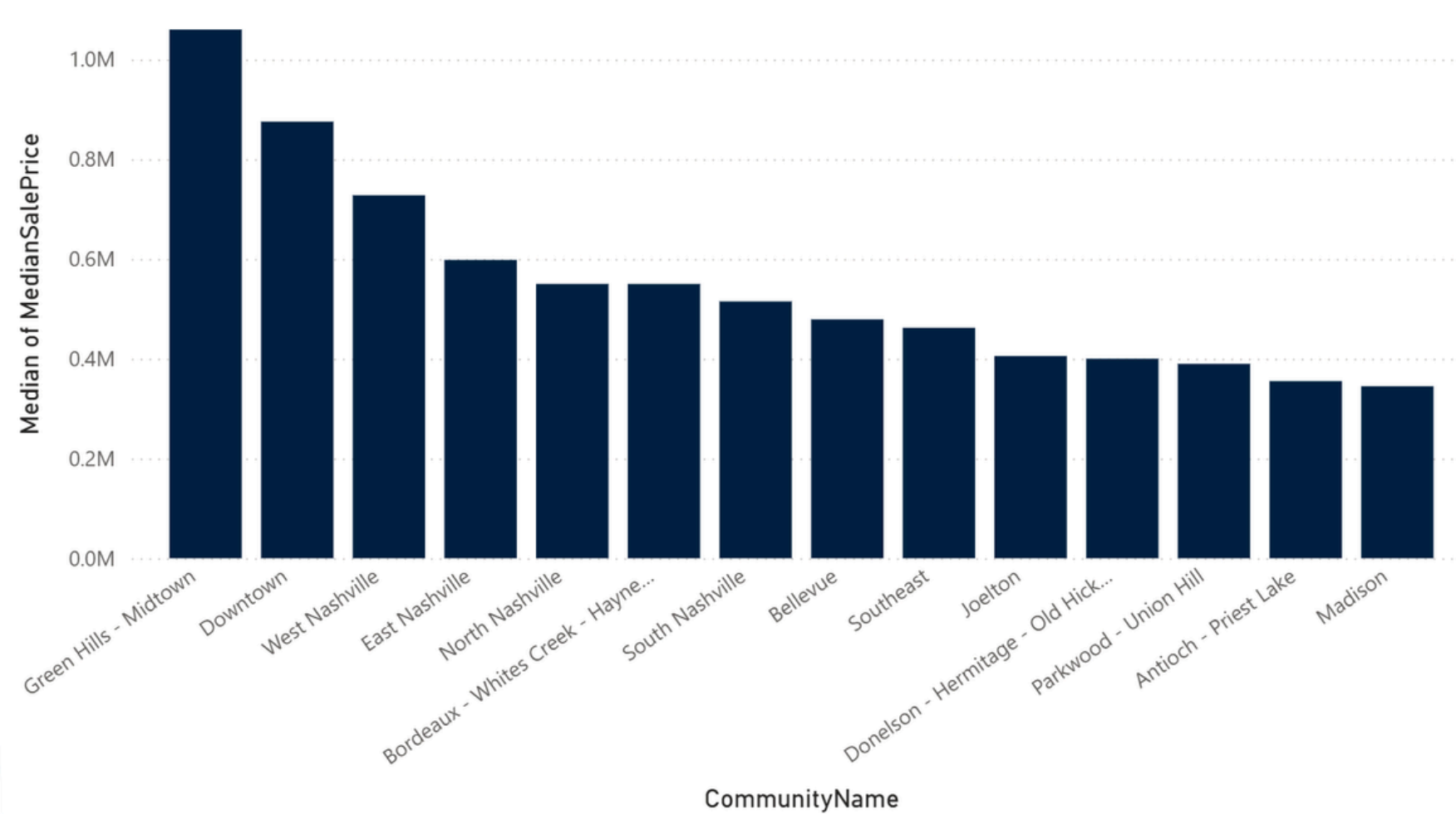
- High zoning capacity + high NTI (Downtown, East Nashville, North Nashville) indicates areas where zoning allows growth and market activity is responding.
- High zoning capacity + lower NTI suggests neighborhoods with room for growth but weaker market signals or slower development uptake.
- Low zoning capacity + high NTI indicates demand is strong but zoning is restrictive.
- Low zoning capacity + low NTI reflects both limited regulatory headroom and limited market pressure.

Why this matters

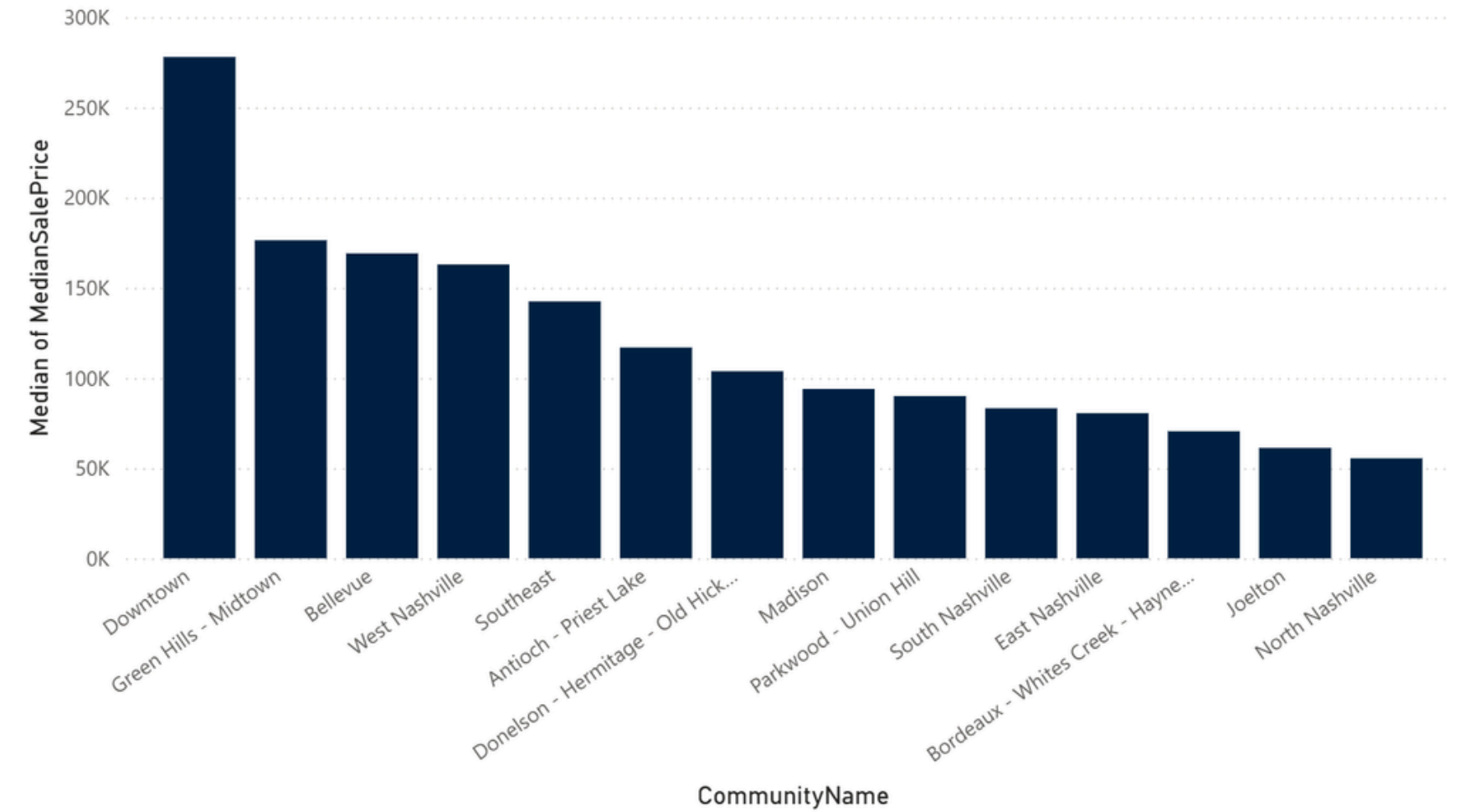
- Zoning capacity is a structural driver of transformation. Understanding where regulatory headroom exists helps explain why some neighborhoods accelerate while others remain stable.

Price Momentum

2023-2024



1900-2026



What these charts show

- The first chart displays median sale prices from 2023–2024, capturing short-term market momentum across neighborhoods.
- The second chart shows median sale prices from 1900–2026, providing long-term historical context for neighborhood price trajectories.

What the comparison reveals

- Neighborhoods like Green Hills–Midtown, Downtown, West Nashville, and East Nashville show both high recent prices and strong long-term appreciation, indicating durable demand.
- Mid-priced neighborhoods (South Nashville, Bellevue, Southeast) show steady growth but less acceleration, suggesting stable rather than rapid transformation.
- Lower-priced neighborhoods (Madison, Antioch–Priest Lake, Parkwood–Union Hill, Joelton) show slower appreciation, reflecting weaker market pressure or affordability-driven demand.

Why this matters

- Price momentum helps distinguish neighborhoods experiencing active market acceleration from those with long-term stability or slower growth.
- When paired with zoning capacity and development activity, price trends clarify whether rising values are supported by regulatory headroom and real construction activity.

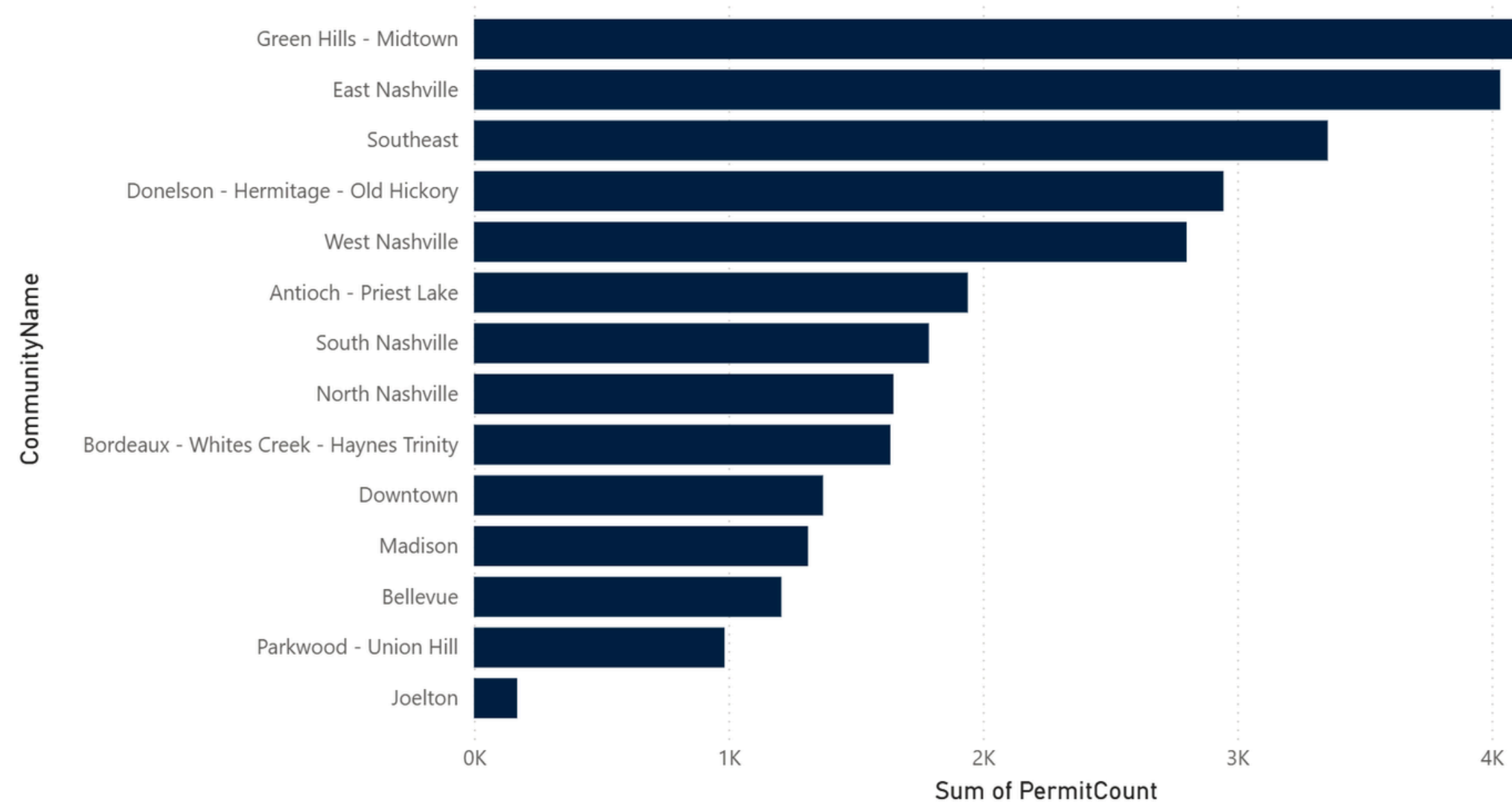
How price trends shape NTI scores

- Strong price momentum amplifies NTI scores when paired with high zoning capacity and active permitting.
- Neighborhoods with rising prices but limited zoning capacity show constrained NTI growth, indicating demand that cannot fully translate into redevelopment.
- Areas with modest price growth but high zoning capacity may represent future opportunity zones where regulatory room exists but market pressure has not yet intensified.

Key insight

- Price momentum is the market signal within the NTI: it shows where buyers and investors are already shifting demand, helping explain why some neighborhoods accelerate while others remain stable.

Development Activity



Development activity measures the level of construction and permitting within each neighborhood. Higher activity indicates stronger investment and physical change on the ground. This metric helps identify where redevelopment is already underway and how it contributes to overall transformation.

What this chart shows

- The bars represent the total number of permits issued from March 2023–December 2024 for each neighborhood.
- Higher permit counts indicate active construction and reinvestment, while lower counts reflect slower physical change.

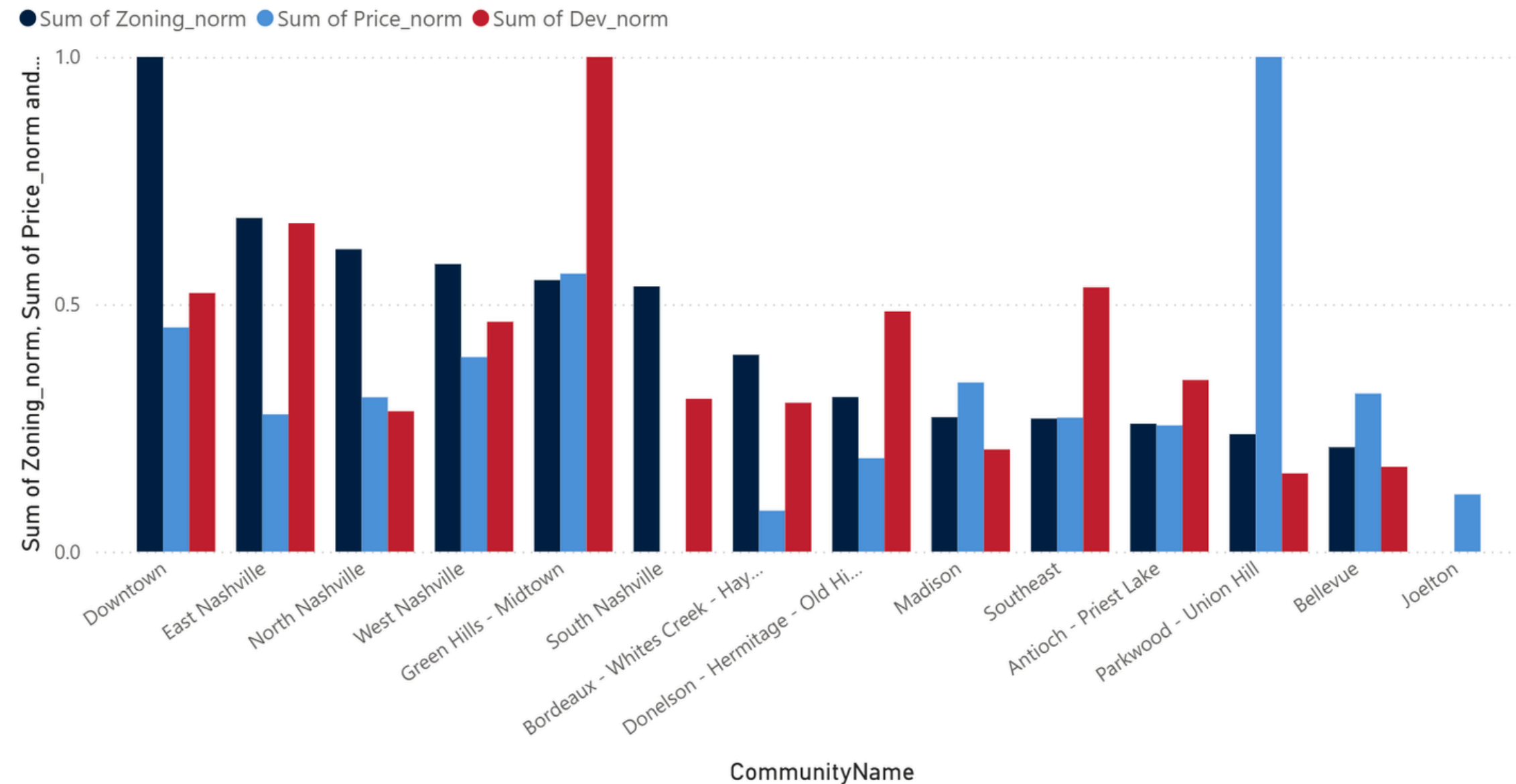
What the activity patterns reveal

- Green Hills–Midtown, East Nashville, and Southeast show the highest levels of permitting, signaling strong developer confidence and ongoing transformation.
- West Nashville, Donelson–Hermitage–Old Hickory, and Antioch–Priest Lake show steady activity, indicating consistent but moderate redevelopment pressure.
- Lower-activity neighborhoods (Madison, Bellevue, Parkwood–Union Hill, Joelton) show limited construction, suggesting either weaker demand or zoning/market constraints.

Why this matters

- Development activity is the real-time indicator within the NTI. It shows where redevelopment is already happening on the ground, not just where it is possible or where prices are rising.
- When paired with zoning capacity and price momentum, permit activity helps distinguish latent potential from active transformation.

Combined Drivers



This page compares the three NTI components side-by-side for selected neighborhoods. Seeing zoning capacity, price momentum, and development activity together helps illustrate how the NTI score is formed and which factors are most influential in each area. Some neighborhoods show balanced strength across all three pillars, while others are driven by a single dominant factor.

What this chart shows

- The chart compares normalized zoning capacity, price momentum, and development activity for each neighborhood.
- Seeing all three components together shows how the NTI (Neighborhood Transformation Index) score is formed and which factor is most influential in each area.

What the combined signals reveal

- Balanced strength across all three drivers (Downtown, East Nashville, North Nashville) produces the highest NTI scores and the clearest redevelopment pressure.
- Zoning-led neighborhoods show high regulatory capacity but weaker market or development signals, indicating future potential rather than current acceleration.
- Market-led neighborhoods show strong price momentum but limited zoning capacity, meaning demand is high but regulatory constraints limit redevelopment.
- Development-led neighborhoods show strong permitting but moderate zoning capacity or price growth, indicating targeted reinvestment rather than broad transformation.

Why this matters

- The NTI is strongest where all three drivers align.
- The combined view clarifies why neighborhoods score differently and helps identify whether transformation is driven by regulation, market behavior, or active construction.

Closing Insights

Top NTI Neighborhood

Downtown	
1	0.69
Sum of NTI_rank	Max of NTI

Strongest Zoning Capacity

Downtown
2.58
Max of ZoningScore

Highest Price Momentum

Downtown
277.96K
Median of MedianSalePrice

Most Active Development

Green Hills - Midtown
8.10K
Sum of DevActivity

Neighborhoods with the highest NTI scores show strong alignment between zoning capacity, rising prices, and active development. These areas represent the strongest signals of transformation across Nashville.

Lower-scoring neighborhoods show limited construction activity or constrained zoning capacity, indicating slower change. The NTI highlights where redevelopment pressure is accelerating and where it remains limited, offering a clear framework for understanding Nashville's evolving landscape.

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